WCAG 2.2 AA Website Audit Checklist

The tests needed for a WCAG 2.2 Level AA website audit. Every one of the 55 A/AA success criteria maps to at least one test below.

Site: _____ Auditor: _____ Date: _____

Test	What to check	WCAG criteria
Tools		
☐ 1. **Automated scan**	axe, WAVE, or Lighthouse on every page in scope. Catches ~30–40% of issues; treat results as a starting point and verify manually.	—
Manual tests		
☐ 2. **Keyboard-only**	Everything reachable and operable; logical focus order; focus always visible and never fully hidden; no keyboard traps; skip link works; single-key shortcuts can be turned off; focus doesn't change context.	2.1.1, 2.1.2, 2.1.4, 2.4.1, 2.4.3, 2.4.7, 2.4.11, 3.2.1
☐ 3. **Screen reader**	NVDA + Chrome, VoiceOver + Safari, and VoiceOver iOS for mobile. Alt text, headings, landmarks, lists/tables, reading order, control name/role/state, status messages announced without moving focus.	1.1.1, 1.3.1, 1.3.2, 4.1.2, 4.1.3
☐ 4. **Pointer & touch**	Targets ≥ 24×24 px or well spaced; single-tap alternatives to gestures and dragging; actions fire on release; motion-triggered features have alternatives.	2.5.1, 2.5.2, 2.5.4, 2.5.7, 2.5.8
☐ 5. **Color contrast**	Text ≥ 4.5:1 (3:1 large); UI components, focus rings, and meaningful graphics ≥ 3:1. Check hover, focus, error, and placeholder states and text over images.	1.4.3, 1.4.11
☐ 6. **Color & sensory cues**	Information not conveyed by color alone; instructions don't rely only on shape, position, or sound.	1.4.1, 1.3.3
☐ 7. **Zoom, reflow & text spacing**	200% text zoom; reflow at 320 px wide (400% zoom) with no horizontal scrolling; text-spacing bookmarklet causes no lost content.	1.4.4, 1.4.10, 1.4.12
☐ 8. **Orientation**	Works in both portrait and landscape on mobile.	1.3.4
☐ 9. **Hover/focus popups**	Tooltips and menus dismissible with Esc, hoverable without disappearing, and persistent until dismissed.	1.4.13
☐ 10. **Images of text**	Real text used instead of images of text, except logos.	1.4.5
☐ 11. **Audio & video**	Captions and transcripts for prerecorded media; live captions; audio description where needed; auto-playing audio can be paused.	1.2.1–1.2.5, 1.4.2
☐ 12. **Timing, motion & flashing**	Timeouts can be extended; carousels and tickers can be paused; nothing flashes more than 3 times per second.	2.2.1, 2.2.2, 2.3.1

	Test	What to check	WCAG criteria
☐	**13. Forms & authentication**	Labels and instructions; autocomplete attributes; errors identified in text with suggestions; confirm or undo for important submissions; no unexpected context change on input; no re-entering data; login allows paste and password managers with no cognitive tests.	1.3.5, 3.2.2, 3.3.1–3.3.4, 3.3.7, 3.3.8
☐	**14. Content & language**	Unique, descriptive page titles; link purpose clear in context; descriptive headings and labels; page lang and language changes marked.	2.4.2, 2.4.4, 2.4.6, 3.1.1, 3.1.2
☐	**15. Consistency across pages**	Navigation in the same order; components named consistently; help in the same place; multiple ways to find pages (nav, search, sitemap).	2.4.5, 3.2.3, 3.2.4, 3.2.6
☐	**16. Code inspection**	DevTools accessibility tree: correct ARIA, sound heading and landmark structure, accessible name contains the visible label.	1.3.1, 4.1.2, 2.5.3

How to apply

- **Sample:** test representative templates plus complete user flows (sign-up, checkout, search, contact), not just single pages.
- **Responsive:** run tests 2–7 at both desktop and mobile widths.
- **Third-party content:** include embedded widgets, chat tools, and linked PDFs if they're part of a flow.